

Advancing Renewables Program

Project Plan Guidance
1 July 2025



Australian Government
Australian Renewable
Energy Agency

ARENA

Project Plan Guidance

A 'Project Plan' is a mandatory application document under the Advancing Renewables Program (**ARP**). It forms the basis of an application's merit assessment along with the ARENANet online submission form and other attachments. It should be stand-alone and comprehensive, referencing attachments as necessary.

This document is intended to guide applicants in developing a Project Plan at the Expression of Interest (**EOI**) and Full Application stages. Please note that:

- Guidance is **indicative only** and should be read in conjunction with the ARP Guidelines, General Funding Strategy, Investment plan, and any Funding Announcements as published on the Program webpage.
- It is the Applicant's responsibility to structure a Project Plan to best support an application.
- Applicant's may use their own templates and styles and include additional content to that outlined below.
- A Project Plan submitted at the Full Application stage may build on the EOI submission, noting that Full Applications require significantly more detail than EOIs.

Note that Applicants are required to contact ARENA via the [ARENANet Funding Advice page](#) to discuss their potential project prior to submitting an application.

Table 1 provides an outline of the key information required by the Program Guidelines that should be included in a Project Plan. This should be **considered a guide only (not a template)** and may be modified as desired to best represent a specific Project.

The symbols below indicate the threshold of information that is required at the EOI and Full Application stages.

- Substantial detail
- ◐ Moderate/indicative detail
- Not required in this application stage (but welcome to include)

Table 1 Project plan guidance

ITEM	KEY ELEMENTS TO ADDRESS	EOI	FULL APPLICATION
Executive summary	• Project overview, ARENA funding request and outcomes. How does the project: • align with and contribute to ARENA's strategic priorities? • align with other national and regional policy, roadmaps, plans etc? • build upon what already exists in the market? • build upon other projects ARENA has already funded (if known)?	●	●
Project Definition			
Background	• Relevant background, nature of the problem addressed. • Relevant work and/or investment to date.	●	●
Description	• Scope summary (details of the project being proposed). • Key objectives/outcomes (success criteria).	●	●
Contribution to Program Outcomes (Merit Criterion A)			
Program Objectives	• Describing how the Project aligns with the Strategic Priorities in the Investment Plan. • Describing how the Project contributes to one or more of the Program Objectives and Outcomes, taking into account the Strategic Priorities in the Investment Plan.	●	●
Pathway to commercialisation	• Details and substantiation of the proposed path to project / technology commercialisation, i.e. what needs to happen for a similar project to	◐	●

proceed without ARENA funding in future. E.g. reduced input costs, lower hurdle rates, overcoming first-time costs etc.)

Capability and Capacity (Merit Criterion B)

Capability	- Details of Applicant and project partners, including roles, responsibilities, experience, and evidence of support for the project (such as letters of support, term sheets). - Experience should cover all relevant skill sets to undertake the project, including (but not limited to) commercial, technical, project management, legal, knowledge sharing, community engagement, regulatory, WHS.		
Capacity	- Details of Applicant and project partners resourcing, including personnel, physical resources and access to supply chains, facilities, equipment, and infrastructure. - This should include the names and experience of key personnel and management, and the individual and total FTE allocated to the project.		
Governance	Project governance arrangements and the nature and status of any required agreements with project partners.		

Project Design and Methodology (Merit Criterion C)

Delivery Methodology	A well-articulated plan for delivering the project, including the objectives and success criteria, workstreams, milestones, and any stage gate(s) or decision points.		
Technical Design	- Details of technical design, including details of proposed hardware and software. - Explanation of current TRL and CRI, and the improvement expected to be achieved through the project. - Relevant Intellectual Property (IP) creation and rights		
Schedule	Detailed project timeline (Gantt chart or similar), including: - Workstreams (with key activities and dependencies). - Proposed project milestones for ARENA grant funding payments. - Any stages and stage gates. - Details and evidence to support assumptions on timings.		
Procurement	Details and status of procurement activities, including land and/or site access, equipment, and contractors.		
Approvals	Details of all required approvals process(es) / licenses / permits to undertake the project, including planning, regulatory, environmental, heritage and First Nations.		
Risk	Summary of the key risks and approach to management and mitigation. Detailed risk information can be included in the Risk Management Plan.		
Community	- Details of community engagement, including identification of stakeholders and engagement activities. - Where the project has the potential to impact community stakeholders (such as local community, First Nations groups), a separate Community Consultation Plan should be developed).		
Funding Agreement Compliance	A table stating any general conditions of the draft Funding Agreement that you do not accept, accept in part or do not consider to be applicable.		

Financial Viability and Co-funding Commitment (Merit Criterion D)

Financial Capacity	Details of applicant and project partner financial capacity and co-funding commitment to deliver the project, including the sources of required funding and any restrictions on accessing those funds (such as applicant investment committee approval, achieving financial close).	🟡	🟢
ARENA grant justification	- Justification of the requested ARENA grant amount that demonstrates the minimum amount of funding required for the project to proceed. - This should be supported with details of the Applicant's (and any funding partners) investment criteria, such as required hurdle rate. - The Financial Model attachment must reflect this justification (such as by showing the project returns / NPV / payback time with and without the ARENA grant).	🟢	🟢
Project budget	- Project budget with detailed cost breakdown, sources and uses of funds (cash and in-kind). - The budget may be incorporated into the Financial Model attachment, and note that the budget covers only the period of the ARENA project, while the financial model should cover the life of the asset for which returns are assessed over. - Evidence for the budget assumptions, such as quotes / orders, industry benchmarking and analysis, prior experience. - Includes the budget allocation for Knowledge Sharing.	🟡	🟢
Contingency	- Details of the budget contingency allowed, including substantiation of the appropriateness relative to state of project definition and risk. - Details of approach to managing cost overruns (above the budget and contingency amounts).	🟡	🟢
Knowledge Sharing (Merit Criterion E)			
Knowledge sharing	- Proposed knowledge sharing audience, activities and outputs (e.g. reports, events, datasets, etc). - Value of the knowledge generated (why is it important and aligned with Program Objectives) - A Knowledge Sharing Plan is required as part of Funding Agreements, and Applicants may develop this for the application.	🟡	🟢



Attachments to your Project Plan

Mandatory and optional attachments are detailed in Part 2 of the Program Guidelines and shown in Table 2, below.

Table 2 Additional Documents

ITEM	EOI	FULL APPLICATION
MANDATORY ATTACHMENTS		
Detailed budget and/or dynamic financial model (in Excel format) calculated over the life of the asset / project, which includes cost breakdown, sources of funding and revenues, and associated financial returns with and without ARENA funding.	●	●
Knowledge Sharing Plan (can be incorporated in the Project Plan)	●	●
Risk Management Plan	⊘	●
WHS Management Plan (can be combined with Risk Management Plan)	⊘	●
Funding Agreement Compliance Table	⊘	●
Evidence of support by participating organisation(s), including their commitment to provide the specified cash and in-kind contributions for the project.	●	●
OPTIONAL ATTACHMENTS		
Supporting quotes for major equipment and other key cost items.		
CVs of Key Personnel (limit of 2 pages per person)		
Community consultation plan		



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